# Wrong for Each Other

## By Norm Foster

**RUDY:** **(Pg 11-13)** Excuse me? Could I borrow this chair? We're one short.

**NORAH:** Sure.

**RUDY:** Thanks.

**NORAH:** *(Recognizing Rudy)* Rudy?

**RUDY:** *(Recognizing Norah)* Oh, my God, Norah. Hi. What are you doing here?

**NORAH:** What am I . . . it's a restaurant. I was hungry.

**RUDY:** Right . . . of course . . . so was I. *(beat)* So, how are you?

**NORAH:** Good, good . . . Would you like to sit down?

**RUDY:** Oh, no, I don't want to intrude.

**NORAH:** You wouldn't be intruding.

**RUDY:** You're sure you don't mind. *(Rudy removes his coat and sits)* Wow, it's been what, four years?

**NORAH:** Three years and nine months.

**RUDY:** Thee years

**NORAH:** And nine months.

**RUDY:** **(Pg 16)** Boy, do you believe this? Running into each other. I mean, a city this size. What are the chances? Talk about your small world. *(Norah laughs as if at an inside joke)* What?

**NORAH:** Nothing

## INTRODUCTION

***TOGETHER:*** *Wrong for Each Other by Norm Foster*

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***Flashback scene to Rudy and Norah's 1st meeting***

**RUDY:** **(Pg 17-19)** Looking for a plant, huh?

**NORAH:** Yes.

**RUDY:** Yeah, I'm looking for one too.

**NORAH:** Well, you've come to the right place. *(Rolls eyes . . . and is not interested in Rudy's "pick-up")*

**RUDY:** *(awkward little laugh)* Listen, could you tell me something? I'm not plant-friendly . . . is there a traditional gift plant . . . that you're supposed to give . . . .

**NORAH:** Well, as far as I know, there's no standard gift plant.

**RUDY:** Ah. I see. Good. Good.

**NORAH:** *(after an awkward pause)* I mean, a lot of people send roses, but that's not a plant. If you send them, they say you sent flowers.

**RUDY:** Right. They don't open it up and say "oh, look, long-stemmed PLANTS."

**NORAH:** Who's the plant for?

**RUDY:** *(hesitation)* My mother . . . . birthday *(Obviously lying) (beat, but not wanting to leave)* Are you buying a gift too, or . . .

**NORAH:** No, just something for my apartment.

**RUDY:** Oh. You live around here?

**NORAH:** Yes, I just moved in . . . a couple of blocks up.

**RUDY:** *(with way too much enthusiasm)* Get out! I live a couple of blocks up! *(Norah responds non-verbally)* I probably walked right past your place on the way here. Welcome to the neighborhood. I'm Rudy Sorenson. *(holds out his hand)*

**NORAH:** Norah Case *(They shake hands)*

**RUDY:** It's nice to meet you, neighbor. *(Rudy makes an awkward exit, then spins back to Norah)* **(Pg 21-22)** Could I call you sometime?

**NORAH:** Call me?

**RUDY:** Yah, call you. Maybe we could go out or something.

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**NORAH:** On a date, you mean? *(She's been put on the spot and she doesn't like it)* Well, gee, this is . . . I mean. *(bluntly)* I don't know you.

**RUDY:** Well, that's why we're going to go out. So you can get to know me.

**NORAH:** **(Pg 24-25)** Well, I don't usually give my umber out to a man, you know, so soon after meeting him. It makes me feel kind of easy.

**RUDY:** [Well, what if . . . . what if . . . ] You meet back here next week and give it to me then?

**NORAH:** No, that's not necessary.

**RUDY:** OR . . . *(very excited at this idea)* how about if you give it to me now and I don't call you until next week? I mean, I might bet busy with work and not be able to call you soon anyway. *(During Rudy's ramble, Norah takes out a pen and paper, writes her number on it)* It might not be until next week or maybe even the week after. In fact, I might not call you at all. I might lose the number. I mean, I'm always losing things.

**NORAH:** Just take the number!

***Back to present day – at the restaurant***

**NORAH:** **(Pg 26)** You called me fifteen minutes later!

**RUDY:** Well, I happened to be near a phone.

***Flashback to Rudy and Norah's 1st Date – The Ballgame***

**RUDY:** **(Pg 27-29)** *(Focused intently on the baseball field and players - yelling)* Hey! Hey, moron. Yah, I'm talkin' to you, ump! You wouldn't know a strike if you were a postal worker! Where'd ya graduate? The University of Ray Charles? Yer a bum! *(Norah is embarrassed and it's obvious from the look on her face – Rudy notices and tones it down awkwardly)* Umpires. They're all idiots . . .

**NORAH:** What, you just yell at people you don't even know?

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**RUDY:** Sure. *(Purchases some peanuts from a vendor and eats one)* It's a ball game. You yell at everybody. The umpires, the players, the guy with the peanuts . . . everybody.

**NORAH:** *(Soaks in this new information, stands determined and then points and yells)* You slut! *(She is proud of herself)*

**RUDY:** *(embarrassed)* Whoa, hey! You don't call the players sluts.

**NORAH:** I wasn't. I was talking to that girl down there in the tube top.

**RUDY:** *(interested)* Where? Well . . . .

***Flashback to scene in which RUDY meets NORAH's father***

**NORAH:** **(Pg 69-71)** *(Norah and Rudy are washing dishes after the evening)* Well, that wasn't so bad. I didn't want to tell you this before, but I was worried about having my father and you to dinner together. I though that he might not like you. But it wasn't like that at all. I think you really impressed him.

**RUDY:** Norah, he threw a dumpling at me.

**NORAH:** What?

**RUDY:** He threw a dumpling at me while you were in the kitchen getting dessert.

**NORAH:** He did not.

**RUDY:** He did. Hit me right in the neck. You can still see the gravy *(touching his neck and licking his fingers)*

**NORAH:** Rudy, don't kid around.

**RUDY:** I'm not kidding. It was like he was saying "Stay away from my daughter, or the next time it'll be a cabbage roll." And then he kept right on eating, like nothing happened.

**NORAH:** Damn it. I thought he did like you. I really did . . . Are you sure you didn't provoke him? *(Rudy looks a little guilty)* What did you say!

**RUDY:** I said . . . . I didn't think I could live with a woman who snores like you do.

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**NORAH:** Oh, great. That's great. **(Pg 72-73)** And you're wondering why he threw a little food at you?

**RUDY:** *(trying to make light of the situation)* It was a joke! Ha, ha!

**NORAH:** Well, that's a childish attitude, isn't it. What if your parents didn't like me?

**RUDY:** *(Trying to keep the conversation light)* Well, they wouldn't throw groceries. I can't see my mother saying, *(in a fake woman's voice)* "Charlie, I don't like this girl. Pass the squash."

**NORAH:** Well, it's important that my father like you.

**RUDY:** All I'm saying, Norah, is that if he doesn't like me, there's not a whole lot we can do about it.

**NORAH:** Well, we'd better find something. He's the only parent I've got.

**RUDY:** **(Pg 74-75)** *(After a moment's thought)* Let's get married.

**NORAH:** Are you crazy!?!

**RUDY:** You know, I think you've missed the magnitude of the moment here. I'm proposing to you.

**NORAH:** I know you are. Now, cut it out. *(She gradually realizes that Rudy is serious)*

**RUDY:** You know, all these years, whenever I've pictured myself asking a woman to marry me, that's not the response I imagined. I though either a buoyant "Yes, I'll marry you," or a tentative, "This is all so sudden," but for some reason, "Are you crazy!" never entered my mind.

**NORAH:** Well, it is crazy. You want me to marry you because my father threw food at you. That's dumb.

**RUDY:** That's not the reason.

**NORAH:** Well, why then?

**RUDY:** Because I love you. *(Norah has no response, though she struggles to come up with a reply)* **(Pg 77)** Okay, listen, maybe I'd better go. I think I've made a fool of myself here.

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**NORAH:** **(Pg 78)** It was a sweet thing to say though. The love part? It was sweet.

**RUDY:** Just don't say it again, right. *(Beat. Norah doesn't answer)* Good-bye, Norah. *(Rudy exits)*

***Back to present day – at the restaurant***

**NORAH:** **(Pg 39)** We didn't have very much in common, did we? We should've seen that. I mean, I liked classical music, and you didn't

**RUDY:** I liked baseball

**NORAH:** And I didn't know much about it.

**RUDY:** And I wanted . . . . *(stopping)*

**NORAH:** Children

***Flashback to the day of Norah's stillbirth***

**NORAH:** **(Pg 79-80)** *(near tears)* Rudy? Rudy?

**RUDY:** I'm right here, Norah. Right here.

**NORAH:** Rudy, I want to hold her.

**RUDY:** Norah, you can't.

**NORAH:** Rudy, please. I just want to hold her . . . Where is she?

**RUDY:** *(holding back tears)* She's gone.

**NORAH:** I want her now! You tell them that. I want her right now! *(Norah dissolves into her grief) (Rudy exits in tears)*

***Flash-forward to 2 months after Norah's stillbirth***

**RUDY:** **(Pg 89-91)** Norah? *(beat)* Norah, your breakfast is ready. *(Norah is non-responsive)* Do you wat to eat?

**NORAH:** *(with little affect or with anger)* I don't know. Maybe later.

**RUDY:** Maybe you should go into work today.

**NORAH:** No.

**RUDY:** Sure, get back into a routine. It'll be good for you.

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**NORAH:** Rudy, I don't want to!

**RUDY:** How long can you do this? You haven't been out in two months. *(beat, softens tone)* It'll be good for you. You'll feel better. I know you will.

**NORAH:** I will. *(beat)* . . . soon.

**RUDY:** How soon? When?

**NORAH:** **(Pg 92)** *(Angry)* When I feel like it.

**RUDY:** Norah, you've got to get over this. It's done. Let's move on . . .

**NORAH:** It's not as easy for me, Rudy.

**RUDY:** You get over it. You **have** to. Otherwise you go crazy.

**NORAH:** I didn't even get to see her. That's what makes it so bad. I didn't get to hold her.

**RUDY:** She was gone, Norah. What good would it have done?

**NORAH:** She should've been held by her mother, that's all. Just once.

**RUDY:** *(Struggles to compose himself)* Look, I've go to go. *(Beat)* I might be late. We've got a job later in the afternoon, so we might no get out of there until seven or eight. . . . I'll see you tonight

***Back to present day – at the restaurant***

**NORAH:** **(Pg 93-94)** *(beat)* Is that when it started?

**RUDY:** Norah, I don't want to talk about this.

**NORAH:** Oh, I see. Extenuating circumstances, is that it?

**RUDY:** We were going through a tough time and I . . . .

**NORAH:** What? [You were] what?

**RUDY:** You looked like you were never gonna come out of your depression. I'd never seen you like that. You were always so strong.

**NORAH:** *(through clenched teeth)* I'd just lost a baby!

**RUDY:** I know.

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**NORAH:** I need time, that's all.

**RUDY:** You kept saying that. You just needed time.

**NORAH:** I needed you too, Rudy, and you went off with somebody else.

**RUDY:** I . . . I . . . I . .

**NORAH:** You slept with her!

**RUDY:** Well, I needed somebody too, Norah. You weren't the only one.

**NORAH:** **(Pg 102)** How dare you? How dare you! I fell in love with you, Rudy. Against my better judgment. And then you made me feel like it was okay to want more . . . Marriage, a family.

**RUDY:** Norah, it was okay to want more. **(Pg 107)** You deserve more. **(Pg 105)** I'm sorry. You're the one for me and I'm the one for you and we should've realized it a long time ago. **(Pg 106)** I'm gonna win you back, Norah.

**NORAH:** No, you're not.

**RUDY:** **(Pg 107)** And I'll never lie to you again, and I'll never cheat on you again, and we'll be happier than we ever were.

**NORAH:** **(Pg 104)** I don't know what we can say to change it now, Rudy. I wish I did. I wish we could go back.

**RUDY:** We don't have to go back. We'll just start fresh from here.

**NORAH:** No. I don't think it's that easy. At least it **shouldn't** be. **(Pg 109)** I don't need this. I really don't. I'm just starting to get things back to normal in my life. Finally after four years. **(Pg 104)** Goodbye, Rudy.

**RUDY:** **(Pg 111)** *(defeated)* Hey, who knows? Maybe we'll bump into each other again . . . sometime.

**NORAH:** I don't think so. *(Norah starts to exit)*

**RUDY:** Yeah, I guess you're right. A city this size? What are the chances? *(Nora turns, then exits)*

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## SOURCE INFORMATION

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## AWARD HISTORY

***2003 National Qualifier***
***2004 National Qualifier***
***2006 National Qualifier***
***2007 National Qualifier***
***2008 National Qualifier***
***2009 National Qualifier***
***2013 National Qualifier***
***2019 National Qualifier***
***NIETOC***
***IL State Finalist***

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